

Philipp Hilbert. *Product Manager, freight intelligence.*

Positioning, experienced Product Manager with 13 years in complex operational domains, ready to digitise freight workflows and ship AI-powered supply chain features at Zencargo.

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Dear Zencargo team,

Freight forwarding is one of the last large operational domains where the daily reality for most participants is still email threads, spreadsheet trackers, and institutional knowledge held in individual heads. That gap between what software could do and what is actually running in production is where I have consistently found the most tractable product problems. Thirteen years of product ownership across operationally complex domains, defence AI, public-sector analytics, insurance, healthcare, payments, has taught me that the most valuable moves are rarely the flashiest features; they are the workflow redesigns that remove a manual step someone has been doing every day for years.

At Rohde & Schwarz I owned an internal AI and data platform for the FCAS European programme. The defining moment of that engagement was instrumenting two competing approaches to a pipeline workflow: a well-designed UI-first path and a developer-code-first alternative. The UI path recorded exactly zero clicks in production. I redirected the roadmap accordingly, and pipeline runs increased by 200%. That discipline, agreeing what success looks like before building, then checking honestly whether it happened, is what I would bring to Zencargo's booking, shipment, and operational automation areas.

At Bundesagentur für Arbeit I owned a national labour-market analytics platform and introduced Dagster and dbt to replace manual data update processes, saving close to 75% of the time per quarterly import. The pattern maps directly to what Zencargo is doing: take a process that experts have been running by hand, model it properly, automate the repeatable parts, and surface exceptions to the people best placed to resolve them. That is also how I read the Luca AI co-pilot, not automation for its own sake, but exception management that puts the right information in front of a freight operator before the problem compounds.

I have been using AI tools as working infrastructure for the past two years: Claude Code for in-repo refactors and spec generation, Lovable for throwaway discovery prototypes, n8n for agentic workflow automation, and GPT for user interview synthesis and requirements drafting. My master's specialisation at TU Berlin was logistics, which gives me a structural understanding of the supply chain domain alongside the product and technical experience I have built since. I am comfortable working with ambiguity, challenging established processes, and making prioritisation calls with incomplete information, which is the only kind of information that exists in a fast-moving freight environment.

I would welcome the chance to talk through how my background fits the specific product areas Zencargo is investing in right now.

Best regards, *Philipp Hilbert*
